REQUEST FOR QUALIFICATIONS

ARCHITECTURAL / ENGINEERING / CONSULTING SERVICES
State of Colorado
University of Colorado Boulder

Notice Number: 26-60
Project Number: UCB001622
Project Title: SITE-NBC-Irrigation Systems and Landscape Improvements
Estimated Project Cost: $2,500,00 - $4,000,000

Table of Contents

I. NOTICES....1
II. PROJECT OVERVIEW....2
III. MINIMUM REQUIREMENTS....3
V. SCHEDULE....4
VI. QUESTIONS, CLARIFICATIONS AND ADDENDA....4
VII/*I. SUBMITTALS OF QUALIFICATIONS....4
IX. METHOD OF SELECTION AND AWARD....5
A. Short List....5
B. Oral Interview....5
X. EVALUATION OF QUALIFICATIONS....6
A. PREQUALIFICATION SUBMITTAL CRITERIA....6
1. PROJECT TEAM....6
2. FIRM/TEAM CAPABILITIES....6
3. PRIOR EXPERIENCE....6
4. PROJECT APPROACH....6
5. EQUITY, DIVERSITY AND INCLUSION....7
6. WORK LOCATION....7
XI. ORAL INTERVIEWS EVALUATION CRITERIA....7
1. PROJECT TEAM....8
2. TEAM CAPABILITIES....8
3. PRIOR EXPERIENCE....8
4. PROJECT APPROACH....8

I. NOTICES

1. For State Public Works C.R.S. §8-17-101 - Colorado labor shall be employed to perform at least 80% of the work. Colorado labor means any person who is a resident of the state of Colorado at the time of the Public Works project.

2. All respondents accept the conditions of this RFQ, including but not limited to, the following:

    a. All submittals shall become the property of the State of Colorado and will not be returned.

    b. Late submittals shall not be evaluated.

    c. The State reserves the right to reject any or all submittals on the basis of being unresponsive to this RFQ or for failure to disclose requested information.

    d. The State shall not be liable for any costs incurred by respondents in the preparation of submittals and proposals nor in costs related to any element of the selection and contract negotiation process.

    e. Any restriction as to the use of submitted materials must be clearly indicated as proprietary. The requested limitation or prohibition of use or release shall be identified in writing on a cover sheet. Blanket claims of proprietary submittals will not be honored. Fee proposals will be considered proprietary.

    f. The respondent has reviewed Appendix B and by responding has agreed that the terms and conditions of the sample Architect/Engineer/Consultant Contract are expressly workable without reservation.

3. The respondent has reviewed Appendix B and by responding has agreed that the terms and conditions of the sample Architect/Engineer/Consultant Contract are expressly workable without reservation. Any exceptions to the contract must be communicated formally in writing before the solicitation closes. Bearing in mind any and all exceptions may be considered non-negotiable.

4. Per C.R.S. §24-92-117, a public construction project in the amount of five hundred thousand dollars or more shall be subject to the Buy Clean Colorado (BCCO) Act program requirements. The BCCO Act requires the Office of the State Architect to establish a maximum acceptable global warming potential (GWP) limit for each category of eligible materials, which include asphalt and asphalt mixtures, cement and concrete mixtures, glass, post-tension steel, reinforcing steel, structural steel, and wood structural elements. For any solicitation for a contract for the design of an eligible project, a State Agency or institution shall require the designer who is awarded the contract to include in project specifications when final construction documents are released, a current Environmental Product Declaration (EPD) that meets the maximum acceptable GWP limits for each eligible material specified for the project. A contractor that is awarded a contract for an eligible project shall not

install any eligible materials on the project until the contractor submits an EPD for each eligible material procured for the project.

5. Preference shall be given to Colorado resident vendors and for Colorado labor, as provided by law.

II. PROJECT OVERVIEW

Introduction

The University of Colorado Boulder (CU Boulder) seeks a multi-disciplined consulting team for the design and construction administration of a new irrigation pond and landscape improvements in the North Boulder Creek (NBC) area of campus. Teams should include, at a minimum, civil engineering, landscape architecture, pond engineering, floodplain engineering, and cost estimation consultants.

Background

Founded in 1876, CU Boulder is part of the University of Colorado system and Colorado's leading public research university. The project will serve the greater University of Colorado system, in particular it directly relates to the system's guiding principles: *Be conscientious stewards of the university's human, physical, financial, information, and natural resources; Provide an outstanding, respectful, and responsive living, learning, teaching, and working environment; and focus on meaningful measurable results.*

CU Boulder Facilities Management is committed to developing and maintaining an environment that enhances human health and fosters a transition toward sustainability. The department is an integral part of the CU Boulder campus and is committed to making it resilient. From engineering high-performance buildings, to implementing an eco-friendly grounds and landscaping program, to running a cutting-edge waste diversion program, Facilities Management is key to making CU Boulder one of the country's most sustainable universities.

The North Boulder Creek district of the CU Boulder campus is currently served by both raw and domestic water for irrigation purposes. The university is a major shareholder of the Smith Goss raw water ditch that traverses the NBC district, and the university wants to better utilize this asset and shift away from domestic water irrigation to a more sustainable approach of 100% raw water irrigation for this entire district. Previous raw water irrigation studies have been performed (see Appendix F 2015 Raw Water Irrigation System Master Plan and Appendix G 2017 Newton & Athens Raw Water Schematic Design) and will help inform this current effort but may not reflect the final direction of design. Proposed solution may incorporate a phased or scalable approach; first phase shall include the Recreation and Athletics fields because of their size and large water use.

The purpose of the project is to reduce potable water use by creating a raw water irrigation system consisting of irrigation water storage, pump station, wet well, and various piping

(i.e. overflow, intake pipe, mainline pipe, ditch piping, etc.). The irrigation system will be a landscape feature that beautifies the NBC campus, reduces nonfunctional turf areas and provides environmental benefits through a more diverse landscape. Different system configurations/types should be investigated for best fit to the campus. Many of the potential sites are located in the floodplain or floodway. This project was identified within the 2021 Campus Master Plan.

The scope of the project will be separated into two phases of work. Phase One will include Pre-Design/Conceptual Design, Schematic Design, and Design Development, and at the conclusion of Phase One, the consultant will prepare a cost estimate of the approved design. Phase One work will also include review and approval by the University of Colorado Design Review Board (Design Review Board). Pending the cost estimate amount and university approval, Phase Two will commence and include Construction Documents, Bidding, Contract Administration, and Post Construction.

The University of Colorado Boulder anticipates using a Design / Bid /Build (DBB) approach to project delivery. The Architect/Engineer is expected to provide Basic Services as described in the sample Architect/Engineer/Consultant Agreement and Terms and Conditions of the Contract unless otherwise noted.

The process to be used in the selection of the Engineer/Consultant is comprised of two steps. In STEP I submittals will be screened and scored as described in detail in Section X. STEP II is the Oral Interview as described in detail in Section XI. A Jury Panel of individuals who will be involved in the project and/or understand the required services associated with the project will evaluate responses to this. Upon completion of the evaluation of the Submittals, a limited number of firms will be invited to the oral interviews.

Submittals are to be submitted electronically via Bidnet at:
https://www.bidnetdirect.com/colorado/universityofcoloradodesignandconstruction

III. MINIMUM REQUIREMENTS

Notice is hereby given to all interested parties that all firms will be required to meet all minimum requirements to be considered for this project. Interested parties should be prepared to show evidence of the following to be considered as qualified, as a minimum:

1. Not previously terminated by the State for non-performance on a State Buildings contract or procurement.
2. The consultant must have been in the same business under the same name for the last two (2) years.
3. Demonstrated design experience in projects of similar scope and complexity for at least two (2) projects each in excess of $ 500,000 (hard costs), utilizing the expertise present in their Colorado Office; and

4. The Acknowledgment and Attestation Form, Appendix C is a mandatory requirement for a respondent to be considered responsive to this RFQ Prequalification Submittal.

    a. Qualifications made by a respondent in executing this form may render a submittal non-responsive as determined by the State.

V. SCHEDULE

The following is a tentative schedule of events for the Submittal process and an outline of the schedule for the balance of the project. All dates are subject to change and changes in the schedule will be issued via addendum.

Request for Qualifications Issued	10/16/2026
Requests for Clarifications Due	10/27/2026, 5:00pm
Final Addendum Issued (anticipated)	10/30/2026, 5:00pm
Submittals Due	11/09/2026, 5:00pm
Selection or Interview Short List Announced	11/20/2026
(Potential) Oral Interviews	Week of 12/07/2026
Selection Announced	12/16/2026
Negotiation of Contract	Through week of 01/11/2026
Anticipated Design Start	01/19/2026
Anticipated Construction Start/Finish	TBD

The above schedule is tentative. Responding firms shall be notified of revisions in a timely manner by email or posted on Bidnet/Rocky Mountain E-Purchasing System (RMEPS) website. Respondents may elect to verify times and dates by email, but no earlier than 36 hours before the scheduled date and time.

VI. QUESTIONS, CLARIFICATIONS AND ADDENDA

Owner initiated changes to this RFQ will be issued under numerically sequenced addenda.
Owner initiated changes to this RFQ will be posted in the form of addenda on Bidnet/Rocky Mountain E-Purchasing System (RMEPS).
Questions and requests for clarification regarding this project shall be submitted before the deadline listed in the above Schedule.
Communication regarding the project during the procurement, outside of this submission process or scheduled procurement milestones is not permitted.

VII. POINT OF CONTACT/CLARIFICATION

Name: Brian Moffitt
Agency: University of Colorado Boulder

VII/*I. SUBMITTALS OF QUALIFICATIONS

1. This RFQ document, its appendices, and any written addenda issued prior to the closing of the solicitation, and written clarifications shall serve as the only basis for the submittal.

2. All submittals must comply with the following items, a through h. The State retains the right to waive any minor irregularity, or requirement should it be judged to be in the best interest of the State.

    a. Qualifications shall be formatted and digitally bookmarked in the exact form and numeric sequence of the Evaluation Form (1 through 7) in Appendix A. A single-page cover letter (addressed to the University of Colorado; Attn: Brian Moffitt) outlining the firm(s) qualifications is required at the front of the submittal. Including the cover letter and required Acknowledgement and Attestation form, the entire submittal is to be no more than (30) 8 ½' x 11" sized pages in portrait format, at least 10 font as one pdf file for the entire submission. No links to external websites are allowed. Electronic copies only.

    b. The cover letter, required Acknowledgement and Attestation form, and tabs **do** count toward the page minimum.

    c. Qualifications shall be evaluated in accordance with criteria as indicated in PREQUALIFICATION SUBMITTAL CRITERIA and ranked on the corresponding Evaluation Form in Appendix A.

    d. Response to all items shall be complete.

    e. All references shall be current and relevant.

    f. Complete and execute the Appendix C: Acknowledgment and Attestation Form and submit at the back of the Qualification Submittal.

    g. An electronic copy of the qualification package is due 11/10/2026 and shall be received no later than 5:00 PM MDT.

    Late submittals will be rejected without consideration. The State of Colorado assumes no responsibility for costs related to the preparation of submittals.

IX. METHOD OF SELECTION AND AWARD

A. Short List

3. The submittals received will be reviewed using the scoring indicated on the enclosed Evaluation Form, Appendix A. Either one firm will be selected at this time or a short list of qualified respondents shall be identified.

    1. Firms failing to meet the minimum required qualifications will not receive further consideration.

B. Oral Interview

4. Oral interviews shall be conducted if firms are shortlisted. Interview times and location will be arranged by the University of Colorado Boulder, and all short-listed firms will be notified in advance.

C. Method of Selection and Award

    5. Submittals will be evaluated by a panel of individuals selected in accordance with state policies. The panel will review and score the submittals and determine if one firm is selected based on submittal scoring

or if multiple firms will be shortlisted for interviews. If the latter, firms ranked the highest will be invited to an oral interview. It is anticipated that no fewer than two (2) or no more than (4) will be interviewed.

X. EVALUATION OF QUALIFICATIONS

A. PREQUALIFICATION SUBMITTAL CRITERIA

Firms will be judged not only on their past experience of the type of work involved, but also on their ability to address issues critical to the success of the project requirements outlined in this RFQ document. The primary focus of the prequalification evaluation will be the firm(s) capability.

1. PROJECT TEAM

   Identify the project principal, the project manager, key staff and subconsultants. Present a brief discussion regarding how the team's qualifications and experience relate to the specific project.

   - Qualifications and relevant individual experience.
   - Unique knowledge of key team members relating to the project.
   - Experience on projects as a team.
   - Key staff involvement in project management and on-site presence.
   - Time commitment of key staff.
   - Qualifications and relevant subconsultant experience.

2. FIRM/TEAM CAPABILITIES

   Organization charts and graphs depicting your capacity may be included.
   - Are the lines of authority and coordination clearly identified?
   - Are essential management functions identified?
   - Are the functions effectively integrated? (e.g., subconsultants' role delineated)?
   - Current and projected workload.

3. PRIOR EXPERIENCE

   Include the name and current telephone number of the owner's project manager for every project listed.
   - Experience of the key staff and firm with projects of similar scope and complexity.
   - Demonstrated success on past projects of similar scope and complexity. Well qualified firms should have previous experience with ditch water irrigation or water quality pond designs that are landscape features.

4. PROJECT APPROACH

   For the project and services outlined in the RFQ document, describe how you plan to accomplish the following project control and management issues:

   - Budget Methodology / Cost Control

a. Establish and maintain estimates of probable cost within owner's established budget.
b. Control consultant contract costs
c. Coordinate value engineering activities
d. Budget Considerations

- Quality Control Methodology
  a. Ensure State procedures are followed
  b. Improve energy efficiency through the use of an integrated design process, life cycle costing, the use of an energy standard (current OSA energy code) and the specification of energy efficient materials, systems, and equipment
  c. Reduce embodied carbon emissions by utilizing and submitting Environmental Product Declarations (EPDs) that meet the OSA's maximum acceptable global warming potential (GWP) limits
  d. Ensure the project is designed for durability and maintainability
- Schedule
  a. Manage the required work to meet the established schedule

5. EQUITY, DIVERSITY AND INCLUSION
   a. Describe how your firm is incentivized to hire and promote diverse individuals
   b. Describe how <u>your team</u> attempts to partner with Service-Disabled Veteran Owned Small Businesses or historically disadvantaged businesses
6. WORK LOCATION

   Describe where the prime and subconsultants will do the key work elements of this project.

   a. Proximity of firm's office as it may affect coordination with the State's project manager and the potential project location.
   b. Firm's familiarity with the project area.
   c. Knowledge of the local labor and material markets.

XI. ORAL INTERVIEWS EVALUATION CRITERIA

(Note that the primary focus of the Oral Interview will be the proposed project management team members' capabilities).

It is anticipated that potential oral interviews will be conducted during the week of 12/07/2026. Interviews will be conducted virtually. The time for interviews is to be determined. Key personnel from the firm and major consultants who will be directly involved with the project should attend the interview. The interview panel will, in particular, be interested in knowing about the specific project approach proposed and in meeting the individuals who will act as the primary contacts with the University of Colorado Boulder. The interview should be structured in the following order:

1. PROJECT TEAM
2. TEAM CAPABILITIES
3. PRIOR EXPERIENCE
4. PROJECT APPROACH

Attachments:

APPENDIX A: EVALUATION FORMS
APPENDIX B: ARCHITECT/ENGINEER/CONSULTANT CONTRACT (STATE CONTRACT FORM SC-5.1)
APPENDIX C: ACKNOWLEDGMENT AND ATTESTATION FORM
APPENDIX D: SCOPE OF WORK & SUPPORTING INFORMATION
APPENDIX E: CU DRB PROCESSES & PROCEDURES
APPENDIX F: 2015 RAW WATER IRRIGATION SYSTEM MASTER PLAN
APPENDIX G: 2017 NEWTON & ATHENS RAW WATER SCHEMATIC DESIGN